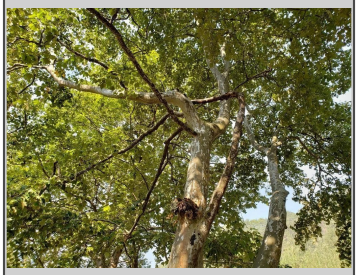
Platanus mexicana

Mexican sycamore, Mexican plane tree

Family: Platanaceae

Rockery: 2 **TOTAL 2**



HABIT

Not available

FALL



LEAF



FRUIT

QUICK FACTS

Plant Type: Tree

Evergreen or deciduous
Deciduous tree with upright rounded crown. Leaves alternate, simple, mostly 5-lobed, to 8 in wide, glossy green above, silvery-white tomentose below on mature trees. Fall color yellow to brown, variable. Bark silvery-gray to white, smooth to exfoliating and mottled. Fruit spherical, about 1.5 in diameter. Faster and more heat/drought tolerant than American sycamore. Leaf undersides become distinctly silvery on trees 4–6 years old

Growth & Size
Rate: Not stated
Size: Typically 50 ft tall and 30 ft wide in landscape; up to 80 ft in the wild. Fast-growing, 3–5 ft per year under good conditions

Sun

Water

Soil
Adapted to most soils, including alkaline and calcareous (up to about pH 8.5)

Zone 8a
Grows well as far north as USDA Zone 8b in Texas and Florida. Oregon State lists hardy to Zone 8. Suitable for Atlanta Zone 8a

ORIGIN AND CHARACTERISTICS

Origin
Native to northeastern and central Mexico to northern Guatemala. Often found along streams in subtropical forests

Form
Deciduous tree with upright rounded crown. Leaves alternate, simple, mostly 5-lobed, to 8 in wide, glossy green above, silvery-white tomentose below on mature trees. Fall color yellow to brown, variable. Bark silvery-gray to white, smooth to exfoliating and mottled. Fruit spherical, about 1.5 in diameter. Faster and more heat/drought tolerant than American sycamore. Leaf undersides become distinctly silvery on trees 4–6 years old

Foliage
Not stated

Flowers and fruit
Not stated

Bark
Not stated

PLANTING NOTES

Siting
Not stated

Soil prep
Not stated

Depth & spacing
Not stated

Best planting season
Not stated

Establishment
Plant in full sun. Provide irrigation for the first 2–3 years. Allow ample space; roots can be aggressive

HEALTH

Health
Resistant to bacterial leaf scorch that affects American sycamore. No serious pest problems stated in primary

Symptoms
None stated